

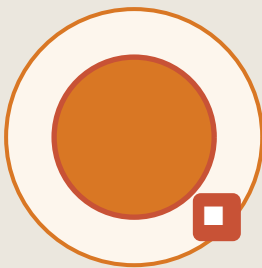
SECOND INNINGS

Mentoring Young Minds (Ages 16–25)

UI/UX & Brand Identity Handover Specification for Designers

The 'Editorial Paper' Architecture • Creative Evaluation & Design Brief

Version 2.5 • October 2026 • Official Platform Document



CREATIVE HANDOVER & DESIGNER BRIEF

Young Minds. New Perspectives. Wider Possibilities.

A comprehensive creative brief and specification manual for UI/UX designers, brand architects, and frontend engineers. Contains complete brand essence, logo assets, design tokens, color palette, typography scales, and interface rules.

Venture / Client:	Second Innings (Youth Mentoring Platform)	Founder & Mentor:	Mr. Deepak Sogani (35+ yrs Leadership)
Headquarters:	Jaipur, Rajasthan, India	Target Audience:	Students (16–25), Parents, Institutions
Public Website:	https://www.second-innings.in	Official Contact:	secondinnings136@gmail.com
Design Archetype:	Editorial Swiss-Paper, Humanist Serif, Zero-Slop	Design Freedom:	Full creative freedom to elevate logo & UI

■ CREATIVE FREEDOM & MANDATE FOR THE DESIGNER:

The logo, brand mark, color palette, and Hero Section design are **NOT locked or predetermined**. We invite you to explore and audit the current live website (<https://www.second-innings.in>) yourself, judge its strengths and gaps from your professional perspective, and **design the Hero section, logo concepts, and visual system based on your creative vision**. This document provides the philosophical foundation, functional constraints, and semantic requirements to empower your creative direction.

SECTION 01 • BRAND ESSENCE & CORE PHILOSOPHY

Brand Essence, Purpose & Ground Rules

Second Innings fills the critical gap between academic education and real adult life. In a world flooded with generic information, young people lack calm, personalized perspective.

WHAT SECOND INNINGS IS	WHAT SECOND INNINGS IS NOT
• A quiet, trusted space to talk openly without fear of judgment.	• NOT a coaching institute, tuition center, or exam prep factory.
• A human-led sounding board for major transitions and career dilemmas.	• NOT psychiatric therapy or clinical counselling.
• A bridge to fellowships, internships, and unconventional life pathways.	• NOT a conventional placement agency guaranteeing job hiring.
• A catalyst for student ownership and evidence-based self-direction.	• NOT an algorithm or AI bot deciding a young person's future.

The 7-Step Mentoring Methodology

#	Phase	Mentor Movement & Objective	Student Movement
01	LISTEN	Create safety. Hear the full story without rushing to offer premature advice.	Felt heard & unjudged
02	UNDERSTAND	Clarify context, strengths, constraints, emotional hurdles, and core assumptions.	Sees own context clearly
03	EXPLORE	Open realistic possibilities, unconventional paths, and questions worth asking.	Wider field of vision
04	PERSPECTIVE	Help compare fit, trade-offs, consequences, market evidence, and long-term viability.	Objective comparison
05	CONNECT	Bridge to relevant professionals, internships, fellowships, and curated resources.	Direct network access
06	ACT	Agree on a concrete, realistic 7-day action step that the mentee owns entirely.	Clear 7-Day action
07	REVIEW	Follow up after 7 days: What happened? What did you discover? What changes next?	Continuous growth habit

The 5 Observable Transformation Pillars

1. Clarity: Moving from cognitive overload to seeing the immediate next step with absolute lucidity.	2. Confidence: Developing self-belief to communicate, interview, and participate without impostor anxiety.
3. Exposure: Access to people, fellowships, and opportunities far beyond traditional classrooms.	4. Action: Converting philosophical reflection into measurable, time-bound, real-world execution.
5. Ownership: Making evidence-based choices the young person proudly owns.	The Benchmark: <i>"After speaking with Deepak Sir, I understand myself better and I know what to do next."</i>

SECTION 02 • LOGO SYSTEM & BRAND METAPHORS

Brand Metaphors & The Zen Ens■ Mark

Designers are invited to propose 2–3 logo concepts based on these foundational brand metaphors:

Brand Metaphor	Meaning in Second Innings	Visual Inspiration for Designer
'Second Inning' / Fresh Dawn	Life transitions, turning points, moving from confusion to a vibrant new chapter.	Dawn horizon, warm morning sun, open book, forward dynamic arc.
Safe Harbor / Active Listening	A calm container where young people feel emotionally safe, unhurried, and unjudged.	Open circle (Ens■), natural ceramic vessel, open journal notebook.
Human Wisdom & Craft	35+ years lived corporate & university leadership; genuine personal mentorship.	Handcrafted stamp / Hanko seal, calligraphic stroke, ink wash texture.
Action & Stepping Stones	The '7-Day Next Step'—mentoring must translate into practical real movement.	Stepping stones, compass needle, progressive arcs, seedling leaf.

Current Reference Mark: The Zen Ens■ & Morning Sun



Anatomy of Current Reference Logo:

- **1. Open Ens■ (Ens■):** Hand-drawn brush stroke in India Ink (#1C1B18), open at top-right for growth and open-minded listening.
- **2. Saffron Dawn Core:** Radiant watercolor sun (#D97724 / #F5A623) symbolizing dawn clarity.
- **3. Hanko Stamp:** Terracotta seal (#C85236) at bottom-right symbolizing authenticity & commitment.
- **4. Wordmark:** 'Second Innings' in humanist Instrument Serif.

Note for Designer: You may refine this mark or propose entirely fresh creative concepts!

Logo Sizing & Minimum Clear Space Rules

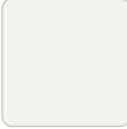
Rule	Specification	Application
Clear Space (X)	Padding = 1.0X of Ens■ inner circle radius on all four sides.	Keeps mark free of visual crowding by text or edges.
Min Size (Digital)	• Full Lockup: 140px width • Icon Mark: 32px height	Ensures brush strokes and seal remain crisp in browser.
Min Size (Print)	• Full Lockup: 35mm width • Icon Mark: 12mm height	Guarantees clean ink reproduction on textured stationery.
Logo Misuse Bans	• Never stretch or distort aspect ratio. • Never add synthetic drop shadows. • Never place inside neon purple/blue boxes.	Protects the handcrafted dignity and warmth of the brand.

SECTION 03 • COLOR SYSTEM & PALETTES

Editorial Paper Substrate & Accent Palettes

The palette is anchored in warm paper (#F4F2EC) as the universal substrate. Pure digital black (#000000) and pure blinding white (#FFFFFF) are strictly avoided for background surfaces.

Primary Editorial Paper Substrate Palette

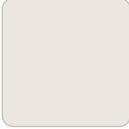


Paper Canvas

HEX: #F4F2EC RGB: 244, 242, 236

CMYK: 3, 2, 5, 0

Role: Universal background canvas

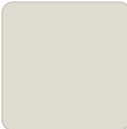


Paper-2 Surface

HEX: #EBE7DE RGB: 235, 231, 222

CMYK: 6, 5, 9, 0

Role: Card surfaces, footer, forms



Paper-3 Hover

HEX: #E0DBCF RGB: 224, 219, 207

CMYK: 9, 8, 14, 0

Role: Interactive hover fills & tags



India Ink

HEX: #1C1B18 RGB: 28, 27, 24

CMYK: 65, 60, 68, 78

Role: Headings, primary CTA buttons



Ink-2 Charcoal

HEX: #3B3934 RGB: 59, 57, 52

CMYK: 60, 56, 62, 54

Role: Secondary text & subheads



Muted Stone

HEX: #6F6B62 RGB: 111, 107, 98

CMYK: 48, 43, 50, 16

Role: Body secondary copy, captions

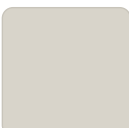


Signal Terracotta

HEX: #B0442C RGB: 176, 68, 44

CMYK: 15, 83, 89, 7

Role: Primary brand accent, links



Line Hairline

HEX: #1C1B18 12% RGB: 28, 27, 24 @ 12%

CMYK: Hairline

Role: 1px Swiss boundary borders

Student Vitality & Life Accent Palette



Sun Amber

HEX: #D97724 RGB: 217, 119, 36

CMYK: 11, 62, 98, 1

Role: Sunrise glow, morning clarity



Sprout Green

HEX: #38784E RGB: 56, 120, 78

CMYK: 76, 26, 81, 12

Role: Growth, fresh shoots, active steps



Sky Blue

HEX: #2B6A8F RGB: 43, 106, 143

CMYK: 84, 48, 22, 4

Role: Wider horizons, calm perspective



Coral Warmth

HEX: #C85236 RGB: 200, 82, 54

CMYK: 13, 80, 83, 3

Role: Human connection, warm tea, seal

Accessibility & Contrast Compliance (WCAG 2.1)

Foreground Token	Background Token	Contrast	WCAG	Approved Usage
Ink (#1C1B18)	Paper (#F4F2EC)	14.1 : 1	AAA Pass	Body text, primary headlines, lead paragraphs
Ink-2 (#3B3934)	Paper (#F4F2EC)	9.8 : 1	AAA Pass	Subheads, form input values, card descriptions
Muted (#6F6B62)	Paper (#F4F2EC)	4.8 : 1	AA Pass	Captions, dates, timestamps, secondary labels
Signal (#B0442C)	Paper (#F4F2EC)	4.6 : 1	AA Pass	Eyebrows, active chip outlines, links
Paper (#F4F2EC)	Ink Pill (#1C1B18)	14.1 : 1	AAA Pass	Primary CTA button labels and icon arrows

SECTION 04 • TYPOGRAPHY ARCHITECTURE

Editorial Serif, Humanist Sans & Monospace

Typography is the primary voice of Second Innings. The system pairs high-character editorial serif display with grounded humanist grotesque and proportional monospace metadata.

DISPLAY SERIF: Instrument Serif • Role: Hero H1, Section Titles, Emotional Quotes, Personal Questions • Tone: Literary depth, calm wisdom, morning newspaper prose, intellectual poise. • Rule: Always sentence case. Never all-caps. Tracking tightened to -0.02em.	INTERFACE SANS: Hanken Grotesk • Role: Body paragraphs, form fields, navigation links, card descriptions • Tone: Crisp, warm, highly legible at small sizes, zero corporate stiffness. • Rule: Maximum 65 characters per line for optical reading comfort.
TECHNICAL MONO: JetBrains Mono • Role: Metadata badges, timestamps, sequence numbers ('01', '02'), step indices • Tone: Structural precision and editorial indexing without clutter.	APPROVED FALLBACK STACK: • Serif: Playfair Display, Georgia, Times New Roman, serif • Sans: Plus Jakarta Sans, Inter, system-ui, sans-serif • Mono: SFMono-Regular, Menlo, Monaco, Consolas, monospace

Complete Production Type Scale

Level	Font Family	Desktop / Line Height	Mobile Size	Tracking	CSS Class Token
Hero H1	Instrument Serif	5.5rem (88px) / 0.95	2.75rem (44px)	-0.025em	clamp(2.75rem, 5.4vw, 5.5rem)
Section H2	Instrument Serif	3.75rem (60px) / 1.05	2.25rem (36px)	-0.02em	clamp(2.25rem, 4vw, 3.75rem)
Subhead H3	Instrument Serif	2.0rem (32px) / 1.15	1.625rem (26px)	-0.01em	text-[2rem] leading-snug
Card Title	Instrument Serif	1.625rem (26px) / 1.10	1.375rem (22px)	-0.01em	text-[1.625rem] leading-[1.1]
Lead (Lede)	Hanken Grotesk	1.1875rem (19px) / 1.65	1.0625rem (17px)	0	lede (max 65ch)
Body Text	Hanken Grotesk	1.0625rem (17px) / 1.65	0.9375rem (15px)	0	text-ink-2 leading-relaxed
UI Small	Hanken Grotesk	0.875rem (14px) / 1.45	0.8125rem (13px)	+0.01em	text-xs / text-sm
Meta Eyebrow	JetBrains Mono	0.6875rem (11px) / 1.40	0.625rem (10px)	+0.14em	meta uppercase font-mono

Editorial Typesetting Ground Rules

Rule	Prescription & Enforcement
Sentence Case Only	Headlines and button labels use sentence case (e.g. 'Start a conversation', not 'START A CONVERSATION'). Title casing screams like an advertisement.
Optical Measure (Max 65ch)	Body paragraphs must never span wider than 65 characters (`max-w-2xl` or `max-w-prose`). Wide full-bleed lines cause ocular fatigue.
Text Wrap Balance	All headlines must apply `text-wrap: balance` to prevent awkward orphaned single words on trailing lines.
Italics for Reflection	Italics are reserved for profound student voice reflections, book quotes, or personal introspective questions (e.g., 'What do I really want?').

SECTION 05 • UI COMPONENTS & INTERACTION DESIGN

The 'Two-Material Rule' & Swiss Hairline Grid

Second Innings resolves the tension between brutalist clarity and luxury elegance through: **The Two-Material Rule.**

MATERIAL 1: The Grid (Paper & Hairlines) - The architectural grid is rigid Swiss print. - Square corners, 1px hairlines using <code>`gap-px`</code> with <code>`bg-line`</code>. - Sections alternate between <code>`#F4F2EC`</code> (Paper) and <code>`#EBE7DE`</code> (Paper-2).	MATERIAL 2: The Objects (Human Touch) - Interactive objects placed onto the grid are softly rounded. - Buttons are rounded-full pills (<code>`rounded-full`</code>). - Form cards have gentle corners (<code>`rounded-[1.75rem]`</code>). Rule: Never round a grid cell; never square an object.
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Signature Component Specifications

Component	Visual Anatomy	Interactive State & Motion
Primary CTA Button (Ink Pill + Arrow Circle)	Deep ink pill (<code>`bg-ink text-paper pl-6 pr-1.5 py-1.5 rounded-full`</code>) containing label text plus an inner circular arrow capsule (<code>`h-9 w-9 bg-paper/10 text-paper rounded-full`</code>).	Hover: Background shifts to <code>`#2E2C28`</code> , nested arrow translates 2px right and 1px up via <code>`cubic-bezier(0.32,0.72,0,1)`</code> . Scale snaps on active press (<code>`scale-[0.98]`</code>).
Secondary Button (Outlined Pill)	Refined 1px ink outline pill (<code>`border border-ink/20 text-ink bg-transparent rounded-full`</code>).	Hover: Border strengthens to full ink opacity (<code>`border-ink`</code>).
Editorial Text Link	Ink typography with a deliberate 1px underline offset by 6px (<code>`underline decoration-ink/25 underline-offset-[6px]`</code>).	Hover: Underline transitions to signal terracotta (<code>`decoration-signal`</code>).
Dilemma Selector Chips (Student Navigator)	Interactive pill chips (<code>`rounded-full border px-4 py-2 text-xs font-medium`</code>). Inactive = paper fill with line border. Active = filled with sun amber or terracotta.	Click: Dynamically swaps the mentor guidance card below with a smooth 350ms cross-fade.
Sticky Card Stack (How It Works)	5 methodology cards stacked vertically. As the user scrolls, each card sticks to the top with progressive z-index and subtle shadow depth.	Emulates flipping through physical index cards on a wooden mentoring desk.
Intake Form Card (Booking & Intake)	Contained in <code>`bg-paper rounded-[1.75rem] border border-line p-8 md:p-14`</code> . Clean input fields (<code>`field`</code>) with subtle 1px border and zero noisy drop shadows.	Focus: Border darkens cleanly to <code>`#1C1B18`</code> with zero garish blue outline halos.

Strict Aesthetic Bans ('Anti-Slop' Rules)

■ BANNED: Generic AI Stock Faces No smiling generic models with backpacks or AI plastic faces. Only real photography of founder Deepak Sogani, authentic student journals, or calm abstract textures.	■ BANNED: Neon SaaS Glows & Purples No purple-to-cyan gradients, floating glassmorphism neon orbs, or crypto-style dark mode glows. The substrate is always grounded, sunlit paper.
■ BANNED: Decorative Meaningless Badges No pill badges with meaningless buzzwords like ■ AI-Powered or 'New v2.0'. Labels in monospace must convey authentic real metadata (e.g. '01', 'Jaipur, India', '45 Min').	■ BANNED: Hyperbolic Silicon Valley Slop Copy Banned marketing verbs: 'Elevate', 'Supercharge', 'Unleash', 'Seamless', 'Disrupt'. We speak with calm clarity: 'Let's figure it out together.'

SECTION 06 • USER FLOWS & TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

Stakeholder Pathways, Intake & Gateway Specs

Second Innings serves three distinct stakeholders with dedicated user paths, shared booking architecture, and built-in statutory compliance.

The Three Stakeholder Pathways

Audience	Core Emotional Need	Landing Route	Primary Conversion Outcome
Young People (Ages 16–25)	Overwhelmed by choices, parental pressure, peer comparisons, or lack of exposure.	<code>`/for-students`</code>	Submits 1-on-1 booking with a single honest concern line.
Parents	Wanting to support without controlling; navigating unfamiliar modern careers.	<code>`/for-parents`</code>	Books a parent-perspective session or refers child with mutual trust.
Institutions (Schools & Univs)	Seeking an experiential student development layer that complements academic systems.	<code>`/for-institutions`</code>	Requests a discovery meeting for a 90-day structured pilot.

Intake, Booking & Gateway Architecture

1. Booking & Safeguarding Intake (<code>`/book`</code>) - Collects Name, Age, Stage (College/School), City, Email, and Mobile. Indian Minor Safeguarding: If Age < 18, dynamically reveals Parent/Guardian consent fields. - Asks one core question: <i>'What would you like to talk about?'</i> (No overwhelming essays). - Direct WhatsApp/phone distractions were intentionally removed from intake form to maximize completion.	2. Flexible Payment Flow (Cashfree PG) Complimentary Mode (Default): Instant booking confirmation with ₹0 fee. Paid Mentoring Mode: Launches Cashfree Production checkout popup supporting UPI (GPay, PhonePe), Cards & NetBanking. - Dynamic HTTPS webhook & return URL prevents checkout failures. - Automatic reconciliation updates payment status directly in database.
3. Channel Separation: Mentoring vs Support Mentoring & Consultations (<code>`/contact`</code>): General questions, partnerships. Technical Support (<code>`/support`</code>): Separate bug ticket desk for portal/booking errors. Official Email: <code>`secondinnings136@gmail.com`</code> WhatsApp: Reserved for warm initial greetings and trust-building.	4. Complete Privacy & Legal Framework - Full statutory compliance with India's DPDP Act 2023. - Transparent data grievance redressal (<code>`/privacy-policy`</code>). - Explicit rescheduling & pro-rata refund guarantees (<code>`/refund-policy`</code>). - Student mentoring boundaries contract (<code>`/privacy-boundaries`</code>).

Full-Stack Technical Stack & Deployment

Layer	Technology	Key Configuration & Role
Frontend Framework	Next.js 14 (App Router)	SSR + Static Generation (36 routes), React 18, responsive editorial layout
Styling & Design System	Tailwind CSS 3.4	Custom semantic tokens (paper, ink, signal, sun, sprout, sky), zero CSS bloat
Animations & Motion	Framer Motion 11	Scroll entry (<code>`y: 28, blur: 8px`</code>), scrubbed text opacity, Ens ■ rotation
Backend API	Node.js / Express 4	REST API with Helmet security, CORS multi-origin, Morgan logging
Database	MongoDB Atlas	Mongoose ODM schemas for Bookings, Payments, Settings, Enquiries, Admin
Payment Gateway	Cashfree Payments SDK	Production PG API v2023-08-01, modal checkout, webhook signature verification
Production Hosting	Vercel (Edge Network)	Apex domain <code>`second-innings.in`</code> + <code>`www.second-innings.in`</code> with SSL & IndexNow

SECTION 07 • DESIGNER DELIVERABLES & SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

Handover Deliverables & Review Criteria

To ensure seamless collaboration and developer implementation, UI/UX designers should structure their deliverables according to the following handover standards:

Category	Expected Deliverable	Format & Specifications
1. Hero Section Exploration	Reimagined Hero section capturing the core promise of Second Innings. Includes H1 typography, lede, primary CTA, and mentor focal element.	Figma Frames: Desktop (1440px wide) and Mobile (375px wide). Responsive autolayout.
2. Hero Interactive States	Micro-interactions for primary button hover, secondary links, and interactive question chips.	Figma interactive components / prototypes demonstrating hover, active, and focus states.
3. Logo Concepts & Identity	2–3 distinct logo concepts exploring brand metaphors (Ens█, dawn sunrise, craftsmanship seal, fresh chapter).	Vector exports (`.svg`, `.ai`, `.pdf`) and high-res transparent `.png` (light, dark, monochrome).
4. Color Tokens & Theme	Proposed color palette in Figma styles with semantic naming (‘paper’, ‘ink’, ‘signal’, ‘accent’, ‘surface’).	Figma Color Styles with documented WCAG AAA/AA contrast ratios for accessibility.
5. Typography Hierarchy	Typesetting scale paired for display serif and body sans-serif. Documented line heights and letter-spacing.	Figma Text Styles linked to Google Fonts or open-source typefaces for web implementation.
6. Audience Flow Wireframes	Layout wireframes for core landing templates: ‘/for-students’, ‘/for-parents’, and ‘/for-institutions’.	Desktop (1440px) and Mobile (375px) wireframes focusing on clarity, warmth, and reading ease.
7. Intake Form Design	Calm, frictionless booking screen (‘/book’) with minor safeguarding fields and confirmation states.	Figma form layout with clean input fields, micro-copy, and zero overwhelming drop-shadows.
8. Developer Handoff Package	Figma Dev Mode link with exportable SVG assets, spacing annotations, and design tokens.	Organized Figma file with named layers, autolayout constraints, and exportable vector icons.

■ EVALUATION & SELECTION CRITERIA FOR THE DESIGN:

- **Emotional Warmth & Safety:** Does the design feel like walking into a sunlit study with a wise mentor, or does it look like a cold SaaS tool?
- **Zero-Slop Authenticity:** Is the design completely free of generic smiling stock photos and artificial neon tech gradients?
- **Editorial Typographic Polish:** Are headlines balanced, line lengths kept to optical measure (≤65ch), and contrasts WCAG AAA compliant?
- **Action-Oriented Simplicity:** Does the interface guide confused young people effortlessly toward starting a 1-on-1 conversation?
- **Frictionless Developer Feasibility:** Can the design system be cleanly mapped into Tailwind CSS and React components?